



'Tis the time to be spending, but what to buy? Tech shopping over the holidays can get confusing. Allow us to suggest a few things for you to splurge on

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You're probably already sick of all the ads screaming out to you from billboards as you navigate your way through rush hour traffic. (And also those in papers, mags...) Every year around *Diwali* (or *Deepavali*), companies put everything up on sale, advertise like mad and hope to win your heart over, along with your *Lakshmi* (money, wealth, paisa, etc.). Friends and relatives all act as facilitators when it comes to decision time—except when it's something from the tech

domain. Here, the majority of we Indians depend a lot on ads. Most of us have friends who know less (or at best, as much) about technology as we do. Those of you who read *Digit* ought to know better than to base a decision on an ad, and should whip out those old issues of *Digit*, or head on over to our site ([www.thinkdigit.com](http://www.thinkdigit.com)) to look at our tests and decide on a product. But this year, we're making it even easier—with our holiday shopping list, sourced from those in the *Digit* editorial team: "If you had a million rupees, this *Diwali* you would buy..." Answers varied across categories, and we present what we're calling "Digit's Ultimate Holiday Shopping Guide."



## Gaming

Because everyone loves gaming!

### Sony PSP

If it's portable entertainment, nothing beats the Sony PSP (PlayStation Portable). There's a new version out called the PSP Slim, widely available with your local grey market vendor. Price varies between Rs 7.5 and 8.5K. So what's so good about it? Well, the Slim (PSP 2000) is lighter than the PSP (PSP 1000)—down to 189 gm with batteries. It has been optimised to use less power. The RAM has been doubled to 64 MB. The screen remains unchanged—480x272 (16:9) wide-screen TFT LCD. The buttons are more responsive and stick out a little further from the body. The drive seems a little less noisy. The Slim features a video-out connector. When you're at home or in a Wi-Fi hotspot, you can connect and start surfing.

For the price, nothing beats the PSP if you're into gaming on the move. If you're a movie buff, however, move on to *Entertainment* (three pages down).

### Microsoft Xbox 360 Elite

This black beauty comes with an HDMI-out—perfect if you're planning on getting an LCD HDTV. The Elite sports a full 1080p HD resolution; it also comes with a 120 GB hard drive, and unfortunately, not much more in terms of features than the regular Xbox models. But well, you'll be able to actually use it as a media centre to play back movies on your HDTV. Besides, with the Elite you get digital audio. And more...

The Elite is supposed to be backwards-compatible with previous Xbox and Xbox 360 games, but this doesn't hold true all the time. However, if you want to enjoy the games you buy in full HD splendour, the Elite is your only option when it comes to the Xbox 360. The Elite is being sold in India at [www.indiatimes.com](http://www.indiatimes.com) for Rs 34,990. We're mentioning both the Elite and the PS3 because choosing between them often comes down to what games you like to play.

We suggest you look at the games available for each platform, decide on which has more of the games you'd like to own, and only then make your purchase. Also, the Xbox 360 Elite is available in the Gulf for considerably less than the Indian price.

